



Appian Interview Experience - Product Engineer Role

Coding Round: The online coding round consisted of four problems aimed at testing data structures, algorithms, and problem-solving ability. Here is a brief overview of each question:

1. **Event Ticket Management System:** Simulate a lottery-style queue reordering system using skip and offset logic, where IPL fans are rearranged in a virtual queue to ensure fairness before ticket sales begin.
2. **Passport Office Efficiency:** Determine how many additional counters are needed to serve vulnerable applicants (children and senior citizens) at a passport office, based on the ages of the applicants and a fixed capacity per counter.
3. **Hotel Room Occupancy:** Calculate the maximum number of hotel rooms that are occupied simultaneously, given a list of bookings with start and end dates. This helps in determining peak room demand.
4. **Store Inventory Search:** Implement a search system to find how many times a query appears in each product name string and identify relevant inventory items based on a given query.

After completing this round, I was shortlisted along with 42 other students for the interview rounds.

Interview Round 1:

The round began with a self-introduction, followed by a discussion around my previous internship experiences. I was asked about the technologies I worked with, specifically Kubernetes, and what I had learned during those internships. They then asked about the role of a Product Engineer at Appian and my understanding of the responsibilities it entails. The conversation moved to my personal projects, where I had to explain one of them in technical depth, along with the technologies used. Next, I was asked core DBMS questions related to indexing and normalization of a table. After that, a coding problem was presented where I had to determine if a student was eligible for a scholarship based on input details like grades and extra-curriculars. I implemented the logic using lists, for-loops, and if-elif-else statements. Two situational questions followed:

- If a product you developed is running slow, how would you approach fixing it?
- If you have an idea and the team is not supportive, how would you handle the situation?

The round concluded with me asking a few questions about the company.

Interview Round 2:

This was a more casual interaction. The interviewer began by asking me to introduce myself again and then discussed my projects. He asked why I had applied for a Product Engineer role despite having significant experience in software engineering. The round ended with me asking questions about Appian's work culture and environment.

Interview Round 3:

This was a short and crisp round. The interviewer mainly focused on my academic background and schooling. He again asked about my interest in the Product Engineer role and why I preferred it over a pure Software Engineer role. Overall, the process was a mix of technical and behavioral assessments, with a strong emphasis on problem-solving, project experience, and role fit.

Tips :

- Be clear on why you're applying for the Product Engineer role specifically. Have a well-thought-out explanation of how your background aligns with the role.
- Make sure to revise key topics like DBMS, DSA, and OOPs, as they can form the basis of both technical and behavioral questions.
- Be prepared to explain your projects in technical depth, especially the challenges faced and how you solved them.
- Be honest and detailed about your previous internship experiences. Know the tools and technologies you used thoroughly.
- Think out loud during situational questions. Structure your approach logically and show problem-solving skills rather than jumping straight to a solution.
- Expect coding questions that involve lists, strings, loops, and conditionals. Practice problems that require processing structured inputs.
- Always ask insightful questions at the end of the interview. It shows interest and helps you learn about the company's values and work culture.

All the very best!!

Vamsidhar Venkataraman

GMail - vamsidhar.venkataraman@gmail.com

Linkedin - <https://www.linkedin.com/in/vamsivenkat/>

Mobile - (+91) 7200093645